

Skills Summary

Counting On Without Slipping

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Count On the Right Way

Rule: Say the start number — but do not count it! Then hop once for each one you are adding: for $5 + 2$, say “5”, hop “6, 7”. The number of hops matches the number being added.

Example: $7 + 2$

Step 1. Counting on means the hops come after the start number, so we say 7 first without counting it.

Step 2. Hop two times: 8, 9 — two hops for the 2. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 7 + 2 = 9$$

Try it: $6 + 2$ (say 6, then hop two times)

check: 8

Skill 2 — Spot the One-Short Mistake

Rule: If the start number was counted as a hop, the answer lands **one short**. Clue: the written count begins with the start number itself.

Example: Jo counted $5 + 3$ as “5, 6, 7” and wrote 7. What is the correct sum?

Step 1. Jo’s count starts with 5 itself, the one-short clue, so one hop is missing and we recount.

Step 2. Say 5, then hop 6, 7, 8 — three hops for the 3. ✓

$$\Rightarrow \text{the correct sum is } 5 + 3 = 8$$

Try it: Li counted $4 + 3$ as “4, 5, 6” and wrote 6. What is the correct sum?

check: 7

Skill 3 — Fix It and Check

Rule: To check a sum, count on again from the **bigger** number, hopping on your fingers. If you land somewhere new, fix the sum.

Example: A friend says $2 + 7 = 8$. Check it and fix it.

Step 1. We recheck by counting on from the bigger number 7, using fingers to keep the hops honest.

Step 2. Say 7, hop 8, 9 — two hops for the 2, landing on 9, not 8. ✓

$$\Rightarrow \text{the fixed sum is } 2 + 7 = 9$$

Try it: A friend says $3 + 5 = 7$. Count on from 5 and fix the sum.

check: 8

(!) Watch out: Fingers help! Put up one finger per hop. If you are adding 3 and you used only 2 fingers, your count started too early.